

# DANIEL PFELLER

SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT · PRE-SALES · GENAI / CLOUD

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*10+ years as a pre-sales technical advisor guiding **Fortune-500 enterprises** and, today, **high-growth unicorn startups** through cloud and AI adoption — from **use-case discovery** → **eval** → **fine-tuning** → **capacity planning** → **production**. Hands-on with **Claude on GCP** and the Gemini API across the full LLM lifecycle. Trusted by C-level executives and founders alike, currently impacting **\$800M** in cloud revenue. Deeply committed to safe, beneficial AI; equally at home in an engineering deep-dive or a board narrative.*

## SELECTED IMPACT

**\$800M**

cloud revenue impacted, 2025

**1st**

production ML model shipped to Chrome (Google Assistant)

**10+ yrs**

pre-sales architect across GCP, Azure, GenAI

**Shipped**

AI side projects live — ski-coach, steeze.it, home automation

## EXPERIENCE

**Customer Engineer (Solutions Architect, Pre-Sales) — Google Cloud Platform at Google** 2017 – present

- Trusted technical advisor across two customer profiles: historical book of **Fortune-500 enterprises** with complex multi-year buying cycles, currently focused on **high-growth unicorn startups** in scale-up phase. Translate business requirements into Google Cloud architectures (data platforms, GKE, **Vertex AI / Gemini / Claude on Vertex**, MLOps) across the full LLM lifecycle: **use-case discovery** → **eval** → **fine-tuning** → **capacity / throughput planning** → **production rollout**.
- Owned technical narrative end-to-end with C-suite stakeholders; impact **\$800M** in cloud revenue in 2025; recurring board-level architecture reviews and executive briefings on GenAI strategy.
- Ran **use-case discovery** workshops translating fuzzy business intent into a shortlist of high-value LLM use cases, scoped for measurable success and responsible deployment.
- Designed **evaluation frameworks** with customers: golden datasets, automated graders, side-by-side model comparison (Gemini, **Claude**, fine-tuned variants), regression gates for production.
- Led **fine-tuning** engagements on Vertex (SFT / adapter tuning) — data curation, training runs, eval, cost/quality tradeoff against base + RAG baselines.
- Sized **capacity & throughput**: provisioned throughput vs pay-as-you-go, latency budgets, regional placement, quota planning for enterprise launch.
- Hands-on Python prototyping with customers: notebooks, API integrations, agents, function-calling, RAG demos on customer data.
- Partnered with Google Engineering & Product Management to feed customer needs into Vertex AI / Gemini roadmap.

**Technical Program Manager — Google Assistant ML at Google**

2022

- Shipped the org's **first production ML model in Chrome** — owned cross-functional program across two ML engineering teams from model handoff to launch.
- Established **evaluation, monitoring, and rollback** discipline for the ML release; defined OKRs and the metrics that triggered a mid-program course correction.
- Revamped coordination for an 80-engineer global program → **+20%** delivery velocity.
- Refocused scope onto highest-value user journeys → **+10%** user satisfaction.

**Technology Solutions Professional (Pre-Sales) — Microsoft Azure** at **Microsoft** 2014 – 2017

- Pre-sales architect through the early enterprise cloud era — drove Azure adoption for the largest accounts in the region when the category was largely uncharted.
- Designed cloud architectures and led PoCs that moved enterprises off traditional IT onto scalable cloud platforms; trusted advisor through complex multi-year buying cycles.

**Technical Evangelist — Microsoft Azure** at **Microsoft** H1 2014

- Conference keynotes, deep-dive sessions, reference architectures, whitepapers, blog posts — teaching cloud-native patterns to the developer community.

**Co-Founder & Software Engineer** at **HaxSync (Android)** 2013 – 2014

- Built Android product reaching **100K+** downloads, **top-100** paid apps, sustained 4.4★ rating — full ownership: product, engineering, support.

**Teaching Fellow — Fundamentals of Computer Science** at **Vienna University of Technology** 2013

- Lectures on programming, algorithms, design patterns to first-year cohort.

**Software Engineer Intern** at **ETM Control GmbH** 2012

- HTML/JavaScript mobile client for a complex SCADA system.

## SIDE PROJECTS — APPLIED AI IN PRODUCTION

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**Ski-Coach App** at **personal** ongoing

- LLM-powered ski coaching app — turns session data and video into personalised feedback and drill plans.
- End-to-end ownership: use-case framing, prompt design, eval loop, deployment, user feedback.

**steeze.it** at **personal** ongoing

- Live AI side project — shipped product, real users, full lifecycle from idea to production.

**Full home & personal-life automation with LLM agents** at **personal lab — Openclaw, Home Assistant, Claude Code** ongoing

- Self-hosted GCP stack running Home Assistant, nginx, MQTT, InfluxDB, Grafana — wired into LLM agents (Claude, Openclaw) to automate household, schedule, and personal logistics.
- Daily driver for Claude API: tool use, automation flows, eval of new model releases against my own use cases.
- Run as a real product on myself: capacity, reliability, eval loop, iteration — same discipline I bring to customers.

## SKILLS · EDUCATION · LANGUAGES

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**AI / LLMs** — Claude API, Claude on Vertex, Gemini API, RAG, agents, fine-tuning (SFT/adapters), evaluation frameworks, prompt design, capacity & throughput planning

**Pre-Sales** — use-case discovery, technical advisory, PoC, architecture, executive briefings, complex enterprise buying cycles

**Cloud Architecture** — GCP, Azure, Kubernetes, Terraform, scalable distributed systems

**Programming** — Python (primary), C#, Java

**Leadership** — cross-functional team leadership, leading without authority, teaching, mentoring

**Certifications** — 3 × Google Cloud Certified Professional · 4 × Microsoft Certified Solution Professional

**Education** — BSc Software & Information Engineering, Vienna University of Technology (2011 – 2014)

**Languages** — German (native) · English (fluent)